

```
② # Destroy existing bullets and create new fleet.
    self.bullets.empty()
    self._create_fleet()
```

We check whether the aliens group is empty ❶. An empty group evaluates to False, so this is a simple way to check whether the group is empty. If it is, we get rid of any existing bullets by using the `empty()` method, which removes all the remaining sprites from a group ❷. We also call `_create_fleet()`, which fills the screen with aliens again.

Now a new fleet appears as soon as you destroy the current fleet.

Speeding Up the Bullets

If you've tried firing at the aliens in the game's current state, you might find that the bullets aren't traveling at the best speed for gameplay. They might be a little too slow or a little too fast. At this point, you can modify the settings to make the gameplay more interesting. Keep in mind that the game is going to get progressively faster, so don't make the game too fast at the beginning.

We modify the speed of the bullets by adjusting the value of `bullet_speed` in `settings.py`. On my system, I'll adjust the value of `bullet_speed` to 2.5, so the bullets travel a little faster:

```
settings.py # Bullet settings
            self.bullet_speed = 2.5
            self.bullet_width = 3
            --snip--
```

The best value for this setting depends on your experience of the game, so find a value that works for you. You can adjust other settings as well.

Refactoring _update_bullets()

Let's refactor `_update_bullets()` so it's not doing so many different tasks. We'll move the code for dealing with bullet-alien collisions to a separate method:

```
alien_invasion.py def _update_bullets(self):
                  --snip--
                  # Get rid of bullets that have disappeared.
                  for bullet in self.bullets.copy():
                      if bullet.rect.bottom <= 0:
                          self.bullets.remove(bullet)

                  self._check_bullet_alien_collisions()

                  def _check_bullet_alien_collisions(self):
                      """Respond to bullet-alien collisions."""
                      # Remove any bullets and aliens that have collided.
                      collisions = pygame.sprite.groupcollide(
                          self.bullets, self.aliens, True, True)
```